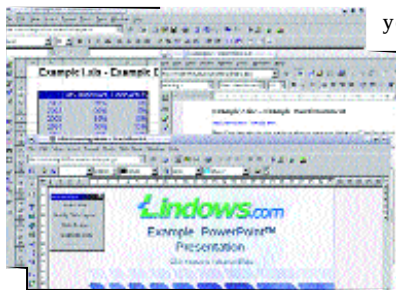


Windows 2.0

Stepping stone to Linux

Lindows, as the name suggests, tries to bridge the gap between Windows and Linux.

The installation is pretty smooth. You can let Lindows take up the whole hard disk, or, if you've already installed Windows, it can share the partition and set up your



computer to boot to either OS. If you have some experience in partitioning hard disks, you can perform the whole process manually.

Lindows 2.0 eliminates all applications it considers unnecessary for a first-time user. That would include over 50 per cent of the applications normally found in other distributions. It might make no difference to a new user, but is certainly a disadvantage for a veteran.

Like most new distributions, Lindows automatically configures a wide variety of hardware, including the network card and the network connection—a definite advantage for the new user.

After the startup, you're taken straight to the graphical interface, which is very similar to Windows. With nearly the same layout, this is nothing but a Lindows version of KDE. Exactly like Windows, in the left hand corner is an L-shaped icon that serves as a start button. From here you can access any program or

Price: Freeware

Web site: www.lindows.com

configure settings for display,
sound, etc.

The interface is extremely simple to use. If you've chosen a dual-boot configuration, Lindows automatically mounts the partitions belonging to the other OS so that it is accessible directly from the 'My Computer' icon in Lindows. If you're on a LAN, you will get an icon called 'Network Browser', similar to 'Network Neighbourhood' in Windows.

On the applications front, Lindows is minimal, but these are sufficient for a non-power user. One feature that stands out is the Click-N-Run. It allows you to

download an application, install it and run it with a single click—a definite improvement over the RPM package management software used by other distributions. However, to use this feature, you need to register with the Web site for a fee of \$99.

Lindows uses WINE (Windows Emulator) to run many Windows-compatible applications such as MS Office.

One cannot deny the extreme simplicity of use, the freshness of the interface, the ease of configuring hardware and the various settings present in Lindows—an excellent stepping stone for those who want to venture into the world of Linux.

SPECIFICATIONS

System Requirements: Intel or compatible CPU at 400 MHz, 128 MB RAM, 2 GB free hard disk space, broadband Internet connection recommended for Click-N-Run

Lindows 2.0		B
Performance	►►►►►►►►►►	
Ease of use	►►►►►►►►►►	
Value for money	►►►►►►►►►►	
Features	►►►►►►►►►►	
OVERALL	►►►►►►►►►►	

Antec Performance Plus 660 AMG

Sturdy and cool

What are the specifications for a top-class cabinet? The basic requirement of any cabinet is a capable power supply, proper ventilation system and sturdy build.

The Performance Plus 660 AMG from Antec is awesomely rugged. The 5.25-inch drive bay front cover is made of plastic and can be removed just by pushing the two side buttons. Below these bays are the 3.5-inch bays. On the front bezel, a small plastic spring-loaded flap opens to give access to two USB and one FireWire connection. The power and reset buttons are present on the front bezel, with two LED indicators and two extra LEDs in case you want to monitor the status of any other device. The only sore point is the reset switch—it's too small and a bit hard to reach.

The cabinet comes with 330 watts power supply with two fans—one normal exhaust at the back of the case, while the other is placed right above the CPU. This design really provides some heavy-duty cooling and is recommended for people using the AMD Athlon CPU. The quality of wiring used inside is splendid, with the motherboard power supply connector wire wrapped in nylon net and all the peripheral power connectors you will ever need. The drive bays are



designed such that the drive has to be fitted to a clip and then slid into the bay—nice and easy. The hard disk can be fitted into the internal 3.5-inch bay cage, which can be removed just by sliding a clamp. The bay is provided with a clamp for a fan; useful if you use one of the faster drives which dissipate a lot of heat. Just next to the hard disk cage is a washable filter

for ensuring clean airflow. Finally, there is space for a stock fan just below the hard disk cage.

Being a mini-tower, it's slightly cramped, especially near the CPU region, due to an irritating cross metal rib that serves as the lateral strengthening device. Also, the power supply needs some sort of support, since it was seen to tilt a bit due to its own weight and due to the dangling cables.

Overall, we were pretty impressed with the build quality and the smart thinking that went into making this cabinet user-friendly. But then all good things come for a price—at Rs 7,650, it's priced way too high by Indian standards.

SPECIFICATIONS

Mini-tower, 17.25x8.1x18.6 inch (HxWxD), seven expansion slots, three 5.25-inch bays, five 3.5-inch bays (two of them convertible), P4 compatible 330 W power supply, net weight approx 10 kg, two USB and one FireWire front connectors, washable air filter

Price: Rs 7,650
Contact: Cyber Space Abacus Pvt Ltd
Phone: 044-4464468
Fax: 044-4915490
E-mail: shunmugavel@theitdepot.com
Web site: www.antec-inc.com

Antec Performance Plus		B+
Performance	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶	
Build quality	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶	
Value for money	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶	
Features	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶	
OVERALL	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶	